TAEWOONG YOON

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https://paleonia.github.io

EDUCATION

Yonsei University, College of Science — Graduation: February 2026
Bachelor of Science in Earth System Sciences — GPA: 4.12/4.3
(Equivalent to 3.83/4.0)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Paleontology Lab, Seoul National University — June 2024 – Present
Seoul, South Korea
Undergraduate, Post-Baccalaureate Researcher

- Conducted research projects on mammalian fossils and taphonomy, resulting in publications and presentations listed below

National Research Project, Long-Term Planning for the Excavation and Utilization of Major Fossil Sites in Korea
Daejeon, South Korea — March 2026 – Present
Research Assistant

- Participated in the National Research project led by the Paleontological Society of Korea
- Contributed to the development of a national paleontological database by compiling research literature

Yonsei University Museum — March 2026 – Present
Seoul, South Korea
Research Collaborator

- Identified Quaternary fossil mammals from cave sites in collaboration with archaeologists
- Developing a comprehensive research project on the evolutionary history of existing museum specimens

Crystallography Lab, **Yonsei University** — March 2024 – May 2024
Seoul, South Korea
Undergraduate Researcher

- Designed and conducted an analytical experiment to investigate compositional differences in a Mosasauridae tooth fossil based on color variation, using XRF and XRD at the Pohang Accelerator Laboratory

PUBLICATIONS & PRESENTATIONS

The first record of Talpidae from the Miocene of Korea and its paleobiogeographical implications
First Author — Poster Presentation, April 2026

- Refined the identification of previous research, attributing it to the family Talpidae (moles).
- Recorded the first pre-Quaternary talpid in Korea and Japan, providing new paleobiogeographical implications

Citation: **Yoon, T. ***, Kim, S., Lee, Y., Byun, E., Sohn, H. (2025). The first record of Talpidae from the Miocene of Korea and its paleobiogeographical implications. JCGS 2026, Research Poster.

Eulipotyphlan Molar from the Miocene Bukpyeong Formation, Donghae City, South Korea

First Author Poster Presentation, September 2025

- Reidentified a lower molar fossil from the Bukpyeong Formation as an Eulipotyphlan insectivore, correcting its previous attribution to Chiroptera, also developed into an undergraduate thesis

Citation: **Yoon, T. ***, Lee, Y., Kim, S., Sohn, H. (2025). Eulipotyphlan Molar from the Miocene Bukpyeong Formation, Donghae City, South Korea. ISAD 2025, Research Poster.

A carapace of *Pelodiscus* cf. *P.gracilia* (Testudines: Pan-Trionychidae) from the Middle Miocene Hagjeon Formation of Pohang-si, Gyeongsangbuk-do, South Korea

Co-Author Published paper, September 2025

- Contributed sedimentological analysis to investigate taphonomic processes and explain how a freshwater softshell turtle was deposited in a marine environment
- Reviewed and verified references to strengthen the morphological diagnosis and comparative framework

Citation: Kim, D., Kong, D.*, Park, J., Kim, S., Kim, S., **Yoon, T.** & Lee, Y. (2025). A carapace of Pelodiscus cf. *P. gracilia* (Testudines: Pan-Trionychidae) from the Middle Miocene Hagjeon Formation of Pohang-si, Gyeongsangbuk-do, South Korea. Journal of the Geological Society of Korea, 61(3), 377-386., https://doi.org/10.14770/jgsk.2025.017

SKILLS

Graphic tools: Adobe Photoshop & Illustrator

Micro-CT: ORS Dragonfly

Crystallography (XRD, XRF): Dioptas & Match!,

Microscopy: Las X (Leica Application Suite X)

Coding & Statistics: Python, R & R Studio

Selected Applications

- GTQ Photoshop certificate - Level 1 (Certified top-level proficiency)
- Applied Python and R for statistical analyses, including calculating key dataset metrics for class project
- Developed a personal website using GitHub and basic web programming
- Participated in ORS Dragonfly Workshop presented by Dr. Jongyun Jung, a postdoctoral researcher in UT Austin

HONORS AND AWARDS

President's Award, The Korean Society of Economic and Environmental Geology February 2026

- Awarded for top research achievements and academic performance at graduation

Yonsei Jinri Scholarship (Merit-based) August 2024 – February 2026

- High Honors for the academic year, Highest Honor for the first semester of 2025

National Resource Development Specialization Scholarship (Merit-based) June 2024 – February 2025

- Awarded based on academic excellence among national R&D program participants

Academic Excellence Award, Department of Earth System Sciences August 2024, February, September 2025

- Awarded to students ranking in the top 3% based on academic performance, ranked first in September 2025

Excellence Award, ROK Air Force Morale & Education Essay Competition March 2023

- Awarded for an essay using a historical case of paleontological fraud to reflect on the importance of truth and integrity in military service

FIELDWORK

National Dinosaur Fossil Excavation Project August 2024

Jeonnam, South Korea

Paleontology Field Worker

- Conducted field measurements of over 20 vertebrate fossil specimens to document size and spatial distribution
- Produced a 10 m columnar section about the fossil-bearing site to analyze the sedimentation and fossilization process

National Resource Development Specialization Field Program August 2024 – December 2024

Gangwon-do & Gyeongsangnam-do, South Korea

Participant

- Participated in a national geoscience training program focused on structural and sedimentary geology

WORK EXPERIENCE

Gangnam-Daesung Private Academy March 2021 – May 2022

Seoul, South Korea

Earth Science Instructor & Q&A Manager

- Taught high school students Earth Science with a conceptual focus
- Promoted to Q&A Manager, providing personalized explanations to more than 100 daily questions.

MILITARY SERVICE

ROK Air Force Academy, Aide's Office May 2022 – February 2024

Cheongju, South Korea

Sergeant

- Provided essential administrative support within the Aide's Office, assisting the Major's Aide to the Lieutenant General of the Air Force Academy
- Served as a Squad Leader, responsible for the direct supervision of a squad of military personnel

CONFERENCES

2026 Joint Conference of the Geological Science & Technology of Korea April 2026

Gangwon-do, South Korea

Poster Presenter

- Delivered a poster presentation and a flash talk on the first reported Miocene talpid fossil from Korea

GSA Connects 2025 in San Antonio October 2025

San Antonio, Texas, USA

Student Volunteer

- Guided participants to icebreaker programs and supported oral presentation sessions as a student volunteer
- Attended various paleontology sessions and actively engaged in discussions with researchers

ISAD 2025 (International Symposium on Asian Dinosaurs) in Japan September 2025

Fukui, Japan

Poster Presenter

- Presented a Poster about the identification process of an eulipotyphlan molar fossil
- Participated actively in paleontological sessions and engaged in scientific discussions

ISAD 2023 (International Symposium on Asian Dinosaurs) in Korea November 2023

Gyeonggi-do, South Korea

Participant

- Attended over 30 presentations by international paleontologists on topics ranging from dinosaurs to bivalves

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

The Paleontological Society of Korea (Student Member) November 2018 – Present

The Korean Society of Economic and Environmental Geology (Student Member) March 2026 – Present

STUDENT ORGANIZATIONS

YSGS (Yonsei Society of Geological Scrutiny) December 2023 – Present

Seoul, South Korea

School Club Executive

- Attended over 20 seminars covering diverse earth science topics, engaging with peers from various backgrounds
- Organized more than five field trips across South Korea, collaboratively exploring paleontological sites

PSY (Paleontological Society in Yonsei) March 2024 – Present

Seoul, South Korea

Founder & Leader of the School Club

- Founded and led a club of 8 students passionate about paleontology, fostering a collaborative learning and discussion culture
- Facilitated over 20 seminars covering all chapters of *Introduction to Paleobiology and the fossil record* and *Vertebrate Paleontology*, encouraging in-depth group discussions and critical analysis
- Organized four visits to natural history museums and coordinated field trips to relevant paleontological sites

AURM (Intercollegiate Debate Club) March 2024 – June 2025

Seoul, South Korea

Yonsei University Branch Leader

- Actively participated in inter-university debates, engaging with students from diverse schools on social and scientific topics
- Elected branch leader, coordinating Yonsei University members' participation and collaborating with other officers to manage club activities

LANGUAGES

English: Advanced proficiency in academic writing, presentations, and research discussions, experience in creating scientific posters in English, TOEFL iBT 106 (Listening 30, Reading 28, Speaking 25, Writing 23), IELTS Academic 7.5 (Listening 9.0, Reading 8.5, Speaking 6.5, Writing 6.5)

Korean: Native Proficiency